MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

Cloud Infrastructure / DevOps | QA Automation Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including 2+ years focused on CI/CD, test infrastructure and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines and builds short-lived test environments using Docker and Helm on a shared Kubernetes cluster. Personal infrastructure projects include a k3s homelab with GitOps-based deployments and Terraform-provisioned Hetzner VPS infrastructure. Brings a measured, analytical approach to improving reliability and delivery, and experience documenting technical processes and mentoring interns. Moving toward a full-time DevOps / platform engineering role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure and delivery: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access; test environments), Terraform (personal projects), Argo CD

Monitoring and data: Grafana, Prometheus, Loki, PostgreSQL

Programming and automation: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, Ansible (basic)

Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

Systems: Linux, Git, k3s, Traefik, cert-manager

Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 basics (personal learning)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software | Wroclaw *2021–Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for 3 product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs decreased by about 30%.
- Built merge-request ephemeral test environments with Docker Compose and later Helm charts deployed to the company's shared Kubernetes cluster. Each environment includes the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data; environments are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky test rate from 7% to below 2%.
- Built a flaky-test dashboard by collecting CI results in PostgreSQL and visualising trends in Grafana, helping teams identify and address recurring failures.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding and authored an internal guide to CI used in onboarding.
- Mentored 2 QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House | Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects through manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project, replacing a full regression process that had previously taken two people three days.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster and deployed applications from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Implemented short-lived environments for merge requests, deployed through GitLab CI and Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Enabled QA and product reviewers to assess features before merge, with end-to-end tests running against each environment.
- Automated environment cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health *2022*

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and separated end-to-end tests into a dedicated stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.

EDUCATION

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology 2018

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam booked for January 2027; currently studying

Terraform Associate practice tests completed; certification exam not taken

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)